

## ashamed

ADJECTIVE

If you feel ashamed, you feel bad about something you have done. *I was **ashamed** of myself for telling a lie.*

## ask

VERB asks, asking, asked

**1** If you ask a question, you say it to someone because you want to know the answer. *"Are you OK?" the teacher **asked** me.*

**2** If you ask for something, you say that you would like it. *He **asked** me for a pen.*

## asleep

ADJECTIVE

If you are asleep, you are resting and your eyes are closed.

## assembly

NOUN assemblies

An assembly is a meeting of all the teachers and children in a school.

## assistant

NOUN assistants

An assistant is someone who helps another person.

## asthma

NOUN

Asthma is an illness that makes it difficult for you to breathe.

**asthmatic** (ADJECTIVE)

Someone who is asthmatic suffers from asthma.

## astonished

ADJECTIVE

If you are astonished, you are very surprised. *I was **astonished** when they told me what had happened.*

## astronaut

NOUN astronauts

An astronaut is a person who is trained to travel into space.

## astronomy

NOUN

Astronomy is the scientific study of stars and planets.

**astronomer** (NOUN)

An astronomer is someone who studies astronomy.

## asylum

NOUN

If someone asks for asylum, they ask to stay in a country so that they can escape from danger in their own country.

## ate

☛ See **eat**.

## athlete

NOUN athletes

An athlete is a person who runs in races or takes part in sports competitions.

**athletics** (NOUN)

The competitions in which people run and jump are called athletics.

## atlas

NOUN atlases

An atlas is a book of maps.

## atmosphere

NOUN

The atmosphere is the air around the Earth.

## atom

NOUN atoms

Atoms are the tiny parts that everything is made of.

## attach

VERB attaches, attaching, attached

**1** When you attach something, you fix it to something else. *First, **attach** the string to your kite.*

**2** When you attach a document to an email, you send it with the email.

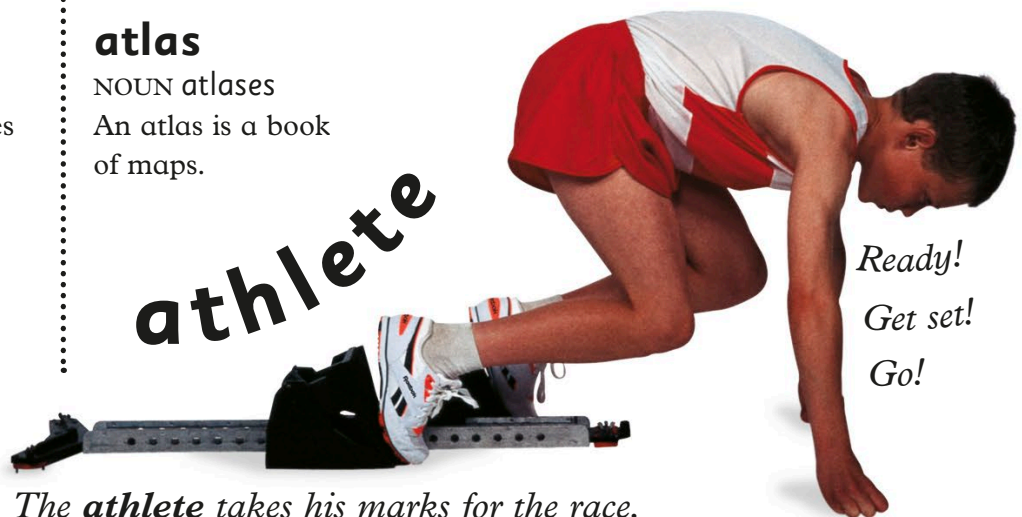
**attachment** (NOUN)

An attachment is a document that you attach to an email.

## attack

VERB attacks, attacking, attacked

To attack someone means to hit them or try to hurt them in some way. *We were worried that wild animals might **attack** us.*



The **athlete** takes his marks for the race.

Ready!  
Get set!  
Go!

Aa

b  
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